

ty.

How do I assess culture fit remotely?

To answer this question, you first need to unlearn a bit, and change your frame of mind. A hiring manager should not aspire to assess culture fit. Rather, you should aspire to assess values fit.

For many, it is assumed that culture is simply the aura, energy, or vibe one gets when walking into an office. This is largely driven by decor and personas in the room. It is dangerous to allow company culture to be dictated by such factors, as this will create an oscillating culture that changes depending on mood or socioeconomic conditions.

A company culture is a company's list of values. Culture is an assurance that each employee respects, admires, and feels invested in a company's values, and that leadership works to ensure values are not violated. As GitLab, an operating principle within our Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging value is "culture fit is a bad excuse."

Remote interviewers should link a company's values during the interview and have a conversation to assess a candidate's alignment and understanding of those values. Particularly in a remote setting, values serve as the north star, guiding every business decision by people you cannot physically see and shaping how colleagues treat one another.

Remote job seekers and candidates

When you're searching for a remote career opportunity, it can be daunting to know where to start. We've curated a list of companies and job boards to help narrow your search, as well as a list of qualities to look for as you're evaluating a potential employer.

Interview questions to assess for success in a remote environment

1. Have you ever worked remotely?
1. What were some of the challenges you faced with working remotely?
1. Why do you want to work from home or a third-space (e.g. co-working space, external office, Codi, etc.)?
1. Have you worked with a distributed team? How did it go? Even if it wasn't explicitly defined as remote work, you can include examples of moving a project forward while traveling, or doing so while your classmates, peers, or colleagues were in a different physical location.
1. What methods do you use to ensure you are communicating with a remote team?
1. How do you switch off from work?
1. Tell me about a time you recognized an opportunity for process improvement and how you brought that up to leadership.
1. Have you ever worked independently without direct supervision on a daily basis?
1. What strategies, tools, routines, or workflows do you use to ensure your day to day goals met?
1. What are some of the things that you have struggled with or you think you will struggle with working remotely and how do you intend to combat them?
1. What excites you about working remotely over working in a traditional office environment?
1. What would you do if you have a piece of work that requires someone in a different timezones help and they are not available?

General remote-work questions

GitLab seeks to learn from others who are embracing remote work. This list of questions is directed at other peers working within a remote organization. Some are aimed at executives and hiring managers. In this video on the GitLab Unfiltered YouTube channel, Sid asks the below questions to InVision Chief People Office Mark Frein.

We are working on a submission process for remote companies who want to engage in interviews with GitLab to share their perspective on these questions and more · stay tuned!

1. What's driving society's appetite for workplace flexibility and remote opportunities?
1. What qualities are important to look for in new hires as you scale a remote organization?
1. How does all-remote contribute to people being themselves/vulnerable?
What benefits have you seen manifest from this?
1. Do you need special leadership qualities to lead an all-remote team, or does what you learn leading traditional teams transfer over?
1. To what degree can remote comfortability be learned?
 - Is it easier to learn/adapt than learning to function in a co-located organization?
1. Do you feel that all-remote organizations contribute to solving cost-of-living, traffic and housing crises in cities like San Francisco and Los Angeles?
1. Do you feel that all-remote organizations are more inclusive by their nature?
 - Is all-remote a mechanism to tackle ageism in the workplace?
1. What's the impact of bringing skilled jobs to rural communities and underserved countries?
 - What kind of GDP-altering potential is there if all-remote itself is scaled?
1. Can existing co-located organizations transition to all-remote?
1. What encouragement would you give new startups today to structure their company as an all-remote entity?
1. What types of businesses are best suited for all-remote?
1. Why do employees apply to work in an all-remote culture?
1. What's the most important communication channel or practice that you use internally to keep your remote team connected and engaged?
1. What advantages do remote organizations have when it comes to building and sustaining their company culture?
1. What are some things you'd encourage newly remote employees to do?
 - Join a WiFi Tribe digital nomad chapter?
 - Consider relocating (temporarily or permanently)?
 - Working in new time zones?
1. How do you weave in-person touch points or communal interactions into your organization?

Interview guests and answers

Below is an archive of past interview guests, answering the above questions and discussing remote work with GitLab team members.

Pick Your Brain interviews

{{< youtube "WBfDA0FF9k" >}}

An archive of Pick Your Brain interviews are below. We've also created a Pick Your Brain Playlist on GitLab's YouTube channel.

Learn more about scheduling a GitLab Pick Your Brain series.

1. GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij and InVision Chief People Officer Mark Frein
1. GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij and FormAssembly CEO Cedric Savarese
1. GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij and Polymail Co-founder and CEO Brandon Foo
1. GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij and Stitch Co-founder and CEO Jake Stein
1. GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij and SaaS.CEO Founder Vincent Jong
1. GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij and Crazy Wisdom Podcast host Stewart Alsop III
1. GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij and Outklip Founder Sunil Kowlgi
1. GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij and Zapier's Mike Knoop and Noah Manger
1. GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij and FineTune CTO Kwan Lee
1. GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij and Buffer CEO Joel Gascoigne
1. GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij and leadership psychologist Banu Hantal
1. GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij and Slab co-founder Jason Chen

GitLab All-Remote Snapshot interviews

GitLab's all-remote culture empowers team members to live and work where they are most fulfilled, and to structure their day in a manner that suits them.

If you have yet to work within an all-remote environment, it can be difficult to fully understand the potential. Each individual is able to approach all-remote differently, leveraging the autonomy it enables to improve one's life.

{{< youtube "QTPeyRW766Q" >}}

In the GitLab Unfiltered video above, two GitLab team members share their experiences on working in an all-remote setting, providing a glimpse at what's possible when embracing this style of work.

To provide insight and transparency into the lives of GitLab team members · and give those considering remote work ideas for structuring their own lives · we ask the below questions in a video interview. While GitLab's entire team is remote, there can be great diversity in answers.

1. Who are you, how long have you been at GitLab, and what do you do at GitLab?
1. What attracted you to GitLab?
1. Was all-remote a big contributor to why you chose to work at GitLab?
1. What notable elements of an all-remote culture have impacted how you structure your day and life?
1. Would you walk us through a typical day in your life?
1. If you were to give advice to someone considering working for an all-remote company, what would you tell them?

Explore answers from GitLab team members in the Remote Work playlist at the GitLab Unfiltered YouTube channel.

GitLab team members interested in being interviewed should message @dmurph.

Return to the main all-remote page.

SECTION: company/culture/all-remote/jobs.md

On this page, we're spotlighting all-remote and remote-first companies, along with job boards that curate high-quality remote roles.

We're also curating a growing list of remote communities, where remote leaders and workers can network and share ideas, resources and job opportunities.

Organizations leading the way

{{< youtube "4bO-wxLQtJQ" >}}

In the GitLab Unfiltered video above, Darren (GitLab) and Rodolphe (Remotive) discuss several remote work topics: favorite things about remote work, how to find/start/thrive in your first remote role, and the impact of the growing remote work community.

Working remotely is becoming more common globally, as supported by data in the GitLab Remote Work Report. While all-remote and remote-first organizations still represent the minority, a variety of trends · from heightened rents in major cities to a greater emphasis on sustainability to a cultural desire to work and live where one is most fulfilled · have more people than ever interested in this way of working.

Buffer's latest State of Remote Work shows that the overwhelming majority of those who work remotely would recommend it to others, while new survey data from Owl Labs collected from 23 countries and 6 continents found that over half of global companies now allow some form of remote work.

Of course, not all remote environments are created equal · a point we cover in detail on the part-remote page.

In the aforementioned Owl Labs survey, it found that 16% of global companies are fully remote and 40% of global firms are hybrid, offering remote options while maintaining at least one physical office.

However, an increasing amount of startups and small-to-medium sized businesses are all-remote. In other words, those looking to work for an all-remote or remote-first organization as opposed to lobbying for a remote arrangement within a colocated company will want to cast their attention on career pages from the below.

All-remote companies

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<div data-bbox="115 867 899 900" data-label="Text">
<p>1. InVision, see their posts about remote-only motivations, building company culture, and what remote work feels like.</p>
</div>

1. Buffer, see their posts about going remote only, the benefits, and how they make it work.
1. Automattic, the company behind WordPress.com and The year without pants fame
1. GitLab, this website is hosted by GitLab, everyone is welcome to contribute to this page, and also check out our handbook for remote work practices.
1. Techmeme, has been fully remote since 2007, utilizing a global team of editors to "curate the technology news site of record for people both within and beyond the industry."
1. 10up, is a fully remote team that works to "make the internet better with consultative creative and engineering services, innovative tools, and dependable products that take the pain out of content creation and management."
1. Zapier, wrote a book on remote work, is 100% remote.
1. Close.com, see their jobs page and blog post about remote culture.
1. Hubstaff, streamlines time tracking and team management, especially for remote teams. Check out the CEO's growth blog.
1. Groove, see their blog on being a remote team.
1. Anybox, see their feedback (in French) Télétravail généralisé, notre retour d'expérience.
1. Screenly, this is how they work.
1. Soshace, see their jobs page.
1. Innolitics, see their handbook which describes how they work remotely.
1. IOpipe
1. HiringThing, see their post about what it is like to work remote-only.
1. SerpApi
1. Scrapinghub, who turns websites into data. See their about us page, open positions, and blog.
1. Jitbit
1. ProxyCrawl
1. Crossover, read their tips on creating the ultimate package for remote work.
1. Toptal, see their Benefits: "Fully Remote, No offices, no useless meetings, no mandatory hours. You're recognized for what you do, not your time in a chair", also see FAQ: "Where do Toptal experts work?".
1. Sonatype, blog article on remote work at Sonatype.
1. Podia, a remote-only company, see their founder's Tweetstorm
1. Knack, a remote-only company, see why they work remotely.
1. Honeybadger, see how they work.
1. Doist, makers of Todoist and Twist. Here's how they make remote work happen, as well as a blog post on not sacrificing one's career ambitions in an all-remote setting.
1. Discourse, see Coding Horror's "We hire the best, just like everyone else"
1. Aha!, see their blog about remote work.
1. Articulate, see their company page for how they work.
1. Nozbe, see what they do, how they work and what are Nozbe's values.
1. DuckDuckGo, see their "Work Whenever, Wherever" Careers page, also see Making Remote Work: Ask DuckDuckGo About Being A Digital Nomad Q&A.
1. FormAssembly, see their jobs page.
1. Gruntwork: see how they built a distributed, self-funded, family-friendly, profitable startup.
1. SoftwareMill, see their distributed teams articles
1. Pangian "Top talent working remotely. Worldwide", see their about page "The fastest-growing remote talent network. Worldwide".
1. Winding Tree, Decentralized Travel Ecosystem built by decentralized team.
1. reinteractive
1. easyDNS, see why they decided to go all-remote.

1. TaxJar, read their blog about building a remote-only culture, their benefits, core values, and hear what employees say about working there.
1. Animalz, an agency providing content to B2B/SaaS organizations
1. Iterative, a company building open-source developer tools for machine learning
1. SearchApi, a remote-only company, see their jobs page

Remote-first companies

Chris H. of Firstbase curates an ongoing list of Remote First Startups. Others are listed below.

1. Basecamp, authors of Remote
1. Harvest, see their collection of stories on Working without borders
1. Niteo, a decade-old Python boutique with a public handbook
1. ElevenYellow, type job openings on their console to join this team of digital nomads.
1. wemake.services, software development company using RSDP
1. Igalia, employee-owned cooperative providing software development consulting services
1. Ad Hoc, see their post "The truth about remote work" and their jobs page.
1. Help Scout, see their posts "What We've Learned Building a Remote Culture," "Employee Onboarding Best Practices," and "6 Tips to Keeping Your Remote Team Connected."

Newly remote companies due to COVID-19

COVID-19 served as a catalyst for many companies to become remote-friendly. In turn, an increasing number of organizations are allowing existing employees to work remotely indefinitely/permanently. Below are trackers which publicize which firms have shifted policies to support remote.

Beyond those listed, COVID-19 has democratized the conversation around workplace flexibility. It is now expected for prospective job seekers to inquire about a firm's approach to remote work and flexibility early in the interview process.

1. Build Remote
1. Are They Remote Yet?
1. ProsperCicle: Remote-First Companies

All-remote and remote-first job boards

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Job seekers are wise to point their efforts towards companies that are built to support 100% remote. You're able to bypass hours of lobbying for a remote arrangement during the interview process, and you're assured that the tools you need to operate effectively from anywhere will be included from the get-go.

While there are myriad job boards that curate part-time and freelance gigs which can be completed from anywhere, this section is focused more on surfacing all-remote and remote-first careers.

Here's a list of 60 remote jobs sites, including:

1. Remote AI Jobs
1. DailyRemote
1. Real Work From Anywhere
1. Startup Jobs
1. Himalayas
1. Better Remote Jobs
1. Remotely
1. Remote Rocketship
1. Grow Remote
1. Torre
1. We Work Remotely
1. Remote OK
1. People-First Jobs
1. Remoters
1. Wellfound
1. Jobspresso
1. Working Nomads
1. PowerToFly
1. Remote jobs on Angellist
1. Remotive - in particular, The List of Awesome
1. Who Is Hiring?
1. JustRemote
1. Remote For Me
1. FlexJobs
1. Remote.Co
1. Glassdoor (toggle the "WFH or Remote" option to filter search results)
1. People First Jobs
1. Remote Tech Jobs
1. Close Sales Remote Job Board
1. Curaiz

> "Getting promoted while working remotely really depends on how remote your company is. GitLab is a fully remote organization with over 700 folks around the world, so getting promoted wasn't difficult at all. In previous roles, I was the only person who worked remotely. In those cases, I felt very forgotten by my employer." - Emilie L Schario, a Data Engineer at GitLab

For a better understanding of the nuances, take a look at "6 People Who Prove You Don't Have to Sacrifice Your Career to Work Remotely" on the Doist blog. Experts from various all-remote and remote-first companies, including GitLab, Doist, Help Scout, DataTrue, and Quuu, share their experiences.

Remote work communities and networking

Staying connected with remote workers globally is in many ways much easier than staying connected with peers through in-person networking events. Working remotely forces you to be intentional about everything, and the same is true for forming and fostering relationships and

becoming part of one or more remote work communities.

As remote work becomes more common globally, there are more opportunities than ever to get plugged in, share resources and tips, and exchange job opportunities. Below are several vetted remote communities with high engagement.

1. Remote-how virtual coworking space

1. We Work Remotely

1. WWR Slack Community

1. WWR Homepage

1. WWR: AMA with Darren Murph, Head of Remote at GitLab

1. Remote Workers in LinkedIn (private group; all may request admission)

1. NoHQ

1. RemotelyOne

1. CreativeTribes

1. Women in Technology

1. Grow Remote

Informal all-remote and remote-first job searching

Keep in mind that many great all-remote and remote-first companies aren't big enough to justify an appearance on conventional job sites. Particularly for startups, hiring is often accomplished via networking and word-of-mouth.

Thus, it's worth a concerted effort to scour LinkedIn (including the Remote Workers on LI Group), Instagram, and Twitter.

Oftentimes, founders will put out informal calls for help through a single tweet, Instagram story, or LinkedIn post. These calls do not make it to formal job boards, yet they represent opportunities to join a fledgling company during a formative time when there is potential to secure a significant stake via equity or stock options.

Each of these platforms support search via hashtag. Be aware that many results will be spam, but diligent searchers can find diamonds in the proverbial rough. Here's a list of popular remote work hashtags below. Where you can, combine searches to include the below along with hashtags such as hiring or nowhiring.

1. remote

1. remotework

1. futureofwork

1. goremove

1. digitalnomad

1. remoteworking

1. workanywhere

1. virtualteam

1. telecommute

1. locationindependent

Working in an all-remote environment is unique. Be sure to read over the distinct benefits and drawbacks when considering if such a setting is ideal for you.

Return to the main all-remote page.

SECTION: company/culture/all-remote/learning-and-development.md

On this page, we're detailing how learning and development (L&D) works in a global all-remote company.

How does learning and development (L&D) work in an all-remote environment?

{{< youtube "trYrbPYOfc" >}}

A GitLab Live Learning session, embedded above and uploaded to GitLab Unfiltered, is an example of L&D iteration.

Credit the conventional classroom environment for implying that learning is best achieved in a face-to-face, in-person setting. That mentality largely translates to the working world, where it is assumed that learning and development is best suited for boardrooms and lecture halls.

In an all-remote company, learning and development can still occur on a face-to-face basis, albeit through webcams and video chat software. Even in colocated organizations, a growing percentage of learning and development · particularly required training courses assigned by human resource departments · are delivered via webcast.

We believe that all-remote companies are at a competitive advantage when it comes to educating and developing team members. Across the spectrum of learning styles, all-remote companies are able to easily scale training sessions, give team members greater agency over their development, and include historical cultural elements in onboarding procedures.

Learn more about learning and development at GitLab in our Handbook.

Benefits to all-remote L&D

Learning and development teams within all-remote organizations enjoy unique benefits, a few of which are highlighted below.

- Faster delivery of training courses: When your company works asynchronously, you don't have to wait for a cohort to be in the same place at the same time to administer updated material.
- Culture isn't lost: Onboarding at most companies involves meet-and-greets and shallow briefs on whatever is pressing at the moment. Institutional knowledge and cultural underpinnings are largely lost due to a dearth of documentation as the company grows and experiences churn.
- Learning is more inclusive: In all-remote settings, individuals can learn in environments that are most comfortable for them · home, a library, a coworking space, a lakeshore, while caring for a family member, etc. This allows those who struggle to focus in group settings, or who have mobility concerns, to embrace education that they may opt out of if the setting weren't ideal.

What are some good resources for developing remote team skills?

Managing any team remotely is much like managing in-person. We've created an in-depth guide on the specific skills needed to be a great remote manager. We have also created a guide rich with tips on managing a remote team here.

Challenges with all-remote L&D

Most challenges associated with all-remote L&D can be addressed at the hiring stage. All-remote companies should seek team members who want to be a manager of one, thrive in environments of high autonomy, and who embrace virtual communication mediums. Learn more about how to hire in an all-remote company.

- No guarantee of uptake: In all-remote settings, educators and trainers must design courses that hold the attention of remote pupils, understanding that they may be engaged with the coursework in highly unconventional settings. In turn, it is difficult to guarantee that participants are truly internalizing what's being conveyed.
- Live feedback/Q&A is hard: At GitLab, we aim to operate asynchronously, staying true to our values of Efficiency and Results. Due to this, it's difficult to find time to hold a question and answer session with a large group of students. Utilizing a Google Doc, where questions can be discussed and answered in real time, is a workaround.

How can teams overcome remote L&D challenges?

Clear communication is one of the best ways to overcome remote challenges. GitLab's handbook captures everything an employee needs to know promoting autonomy and efficiency for communication, processes, and procedures by putting everything in one place.

Managers can set, share, and track team goals, or "objectives and key results" (OKRs) for visibility across the team and company.

One potential downside for all-remote teams is having timely and adequate access to people and information. Managers can ensure everyone has the needed access to information by documenting everything.

The importance of documenting everything

{{< youtube "ejlb9tPzjZs?start=1510" >}}

In the GitLab Unfiltered video above, GitLab team members discuss the challenges and reasoning behind intentional documentation with Miki and Sandra from Job Portraits.

Learning involves much more than comprehending what's necessary to complete a job. In fact, we hope candidates aspire to learn about GitLab's history, all-remote culture, and values prior to joining the company.

The above would be difficult, if not impossible, to achieve without a commitment to documentation.

Particularly in all-remote companies · where everything from interviewing to onboarding to

career development takes place outside of a central office · regimented documentation is the only way to ensure future team members have access to the same information as past and current team members. Even if you've already started a company but have failed to document key learnings, it's never too late to start.

Handbook first

GitLab's Handbook would cover thousands of pages if printed. Each page is loaded with institutional knowledge on important topics like hiring, values, and benefits. Content is contributed, refreshed, and refined by hundreds of team members across the company.

We encourage other all-remote companies to adopt this handbook first approach. Simply, we default to adding knowledge to our handbook before disseminating elsewhere. Learn more about GitLab's handbook-first approach to documentation.

From a learning and development standpoint, this approach ensures that all team members have access to all learnings · past, present, and future · at all times. This is a highly inclusive way to manage knowledge, and it reflects our mission to change all creative work from read-only to read-write so that everyone can contribute.

Learning and development as a mindset

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We encourage companies to consider GitLab (the product) to manage L&D within their own handbook. With a merge request, for instance, any team member can suggest new learnings to the appropriate places. Colleagues and those managing learning and development can comment, add feedback, and shape what is eventually added.

This is powerful in that it encourages team members to continually be mindful of new learnings, and to not keep those learnings to themselves. Said another way, all-remote teams are ideally positioned to contribute to learning and development, rather than simply waiting for the L&D team to generate new material to ingest.

This creates an atmosphere where all team members are hungry to learn from one another. Indeed, those in charge of learning and development in an all-remote company should look to colleagues across the organization to understand which areas are most misunderstood, and what modules would generate the most interest.

Responsibilities from managers and leaders

GitLab's 100% remote culture and our workplace methodologies are highly unique. You should not expect to transfer the norms of colocated corporations into a work from anywhere scenario. Those who thrive at GitLab take the opportunity to drop prior workplace baggage at the door, embrace a liberating and empowering set of values, and give themselves permission to truly operate differently.

So differently, in fact, that many of GitLab's most effective processes would be discouraged or forbidden in conventional corporations.

Hence, GitLab managers are expected to coach their reports to utilize asynchronous communication, be handbook-first, design an optimal workspace, and understand the importance of self-learning/self-service.

What are some best practices for remote team management of L&D initiatives?

One of the best ways to keep a remote team aligned is to regularly review the Learning and Development Team's Purpose, Vision, Mission, and Objectives.

GitLab's L&D team has a regular meeting schedule to brainstorm, strategize, discuss and collaborate, assign tasks, review feedback or data, and assess progress on the team's strategy and roadmap.

What are some tips for building a successful remote team L&D program?

For a remote team to work well, managers should coach their team in healthy remote-work practices such as:

- asynchronous communication
- working handbook-first
- creating an optimal workspace
- understanding the importance of self-learning/self-service.

To stay ahead in L&D, GitLab prioritizes personal Growth & Development opportunities by allowing team members to take advantage of training opportunities for professional development, certifications, workshops, coaching, language courses, and much more!

Trust and communication

{{< youtube "RAp70i5s57Y?start=394" >}}

In the GitLab Unfiltered video above, senior backend engineer Charlie A. describes her experience working in an all-remote setting, from onboarding to fully embracing autonomy.

> I've been challenged to be able to say, 'It's OK for me to not know this.' It's OK for me to ask somebody else and not feel bad about it. It's OK to not know everything. In this kind of setting, it's impossible for one person to know everything, so you have to rely on your coworkers to tell you.

>

> Impeccable communication and trust is the backbone of any relationship. When it comes to a working environment, those elements] make it much easier to do what you need to do. - [Charlie A. · Senior Backend Engineer

company-wide trust and impeccable communication serve as the bedrock for learning and development in any company, all-remote organizations included. This relies on a set of values that encourages behaviors which are at odds with micromanagement.

Leaders should create a climate for employees where they are eager to learn new skills and improved processes rather than political tactics. For this to occur, each team member must be trusted and empowered to make decisions based on their professional experience and skill set.

This is manifested through behaviors such as reaching across departments, asking for help with no fear of judgment or embarrassment, and speaking up when values are not adhered to.

Proper learning and development requires more than a curriculum. It requires an atmosphere where people are unafraid and unashamed to learn, recognizing that those efforts will be encouraged and supported.

How do you onboard new team members?

{{< youtube "CH-NHoBOeho?start=609" >}}

In the Traction Conference video above, GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij shares how onboarding works within an all-remote setting with Frederic Lardinois of TechCrunch.

At a high level, this is how new team members are onboarded at GitLab.

1. On a new hire's first day, they are invited to create a GitLab account
1. Within their GitLab account is an onboarding issue with over 200 tasks, including GitLab's Guide to Starting a Remote Role
 - Onboarding items are extremely prescriptive
 - Rather than bundling a complex series of asks into one "task," as is common elsewhere, GitLab strives to remove ambiguity
1. Each new hire is assigned an Onboarding Buddy as an added resource beyond the individual's manager
 - The Onboarding Buddy is a serious role, replete with its own Handbook page
 - The Onboarding Buddy provides assistance in any way, where no question is silly or too minute, to ensure the new hire has all questions addressed
 - If a concern or obstacle is surfaced to the Onboarding Buddy, and there is no solution in the Handbook, the Onboarding Buddy works with the new hire to create a merge request for the enlightenment of all future new hires
1. The onboarding process is self-directed and self-guided, with new hires encouraged to lean on documentation in the Handbook · as well as conversing with any GitLab team member · to get up to speed.

Read more in GitLab's complete guide to remote onboarding.

High-touch and low-touch flexibility

The beauty of an all-remote setting is that onboarding can be as high-touch or low-touch as a new hire wishes. Those who prefer visual learning can engage in a series of video calls and screen share sessions to walk through each element of their onboarding issue.

That flexibility is unique to the all-remote environment, as those who prefer a self-guided experience are typically forced into a very social onboarding at colocated companies.

Empowerment from day one

GitLab's onboarding process is empowering. If a new hire gets stuck during onboarding, they are encouraged to update the Handbook, record a video to help others who may encounter the same obstacle, and contribute to learning and development from day one.

At GitLab, new hires are onboarded using GitLab (the product). We believe in using the tools we create. This allows new hires to become familiar with GitLab in a way that feels meaningful (e.g. in learning GitLab, they are also accomplishing necessary onboarding tasks). This also provides a continual set of new users to test GitLab with fresh eyes. These individuals are ideally positioned to point out missing features or areas for improvement as we iterate on the product.

Learn more about GitLab Onboarding in our Handbook.

What are some useful tools and resources for developing a remote (L&D) program?

Clearly outline job families

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All-remote companies should strive for a single source of truth in all facets of running the business, including job families. Job families and their descriptions should be accessible to all from day one. GitLab makes these descriptions available even to prospective team members in the Job Families section of our Handbook, reinforcing our Transparency value.

This removes ambiguity about how the company functions, how it is organized, and what each position is responsible for.

From a learning and development standpoint, this transparency is vital in providing clarity in career development. In role levels, requirements for each are clearly listed. This also allows team members to find colleagues in functions outside of their own that they are interested in learning more about.

Recording meetings and trainings for asynchronous learning

{{< youtube "Cxs5EMHNf6g" >}}

In the video above, published on the GitLab Unfiltered YouTube channel, Chrissie B. documents a question from a fellow GitLab team member · "How do you create a blog post as a non-technical user?" · by capturing the answer and walkthrough on video.

This is a classic example of a GitLab team member answering once so that multitudes will benefit, reinforcing our Efficiency value. Notice that Chrissie's primary function is not within learning and development, yet her contribution leads to a more educated workforce.

{{< youtube "7RbVQwU69H0" >}}

In the video above, published on the GitLab YouTube channel, a member of the People Operations team conducts a training on decision making. Being unable to attend in person matters not, as the training is archived for later viewing.

Encourage team members to collect notes when attending conferences

Encourage team members to collect notes when attending conferences and distribute those notes

to their team and other interested teams after the conference.

The attendees are encouraged to collect notes in a Google document and distribute the link via Slack channel(s) and other methods as appropriate.

Example:

- Kubecon 2019 notes. This document contains:
 - Pictures of interesting slides
 - Notes on those slides written by the conference attendees
 - Links to interesting presentations and documents from the conference
- Link to document distributed to Slack channels for the Protect team and Engineering overall
- Link to document added to Engineering week in review document.

Ask Me Anything (AMA), and Key Reviews

All-remote companies should embrace learning and development not as something done during once during onboarding and then once or twice per year, but as a continual operation. GitLab encourages team members to also learn from each other, as the below methods demonstrate.

AMA

Reinforcing GitLab's Transparency value, we routinely encourage the entire company to join for AMAs (Ask Me Anything), where individuals can pose questions to executives. This not only allows team members to learn from leaders, but it allows leaders to learn more about what matters to team members and those they serve.

{{< youtube "u1jv1HOc8fw" >}}

In the video above, published on the GitLab Unfiltered YouTube channel, GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij conducts an AMA.

Here are a few other examples of AMAs:

1. AMA with David Hornik (Board Member)
1. AMA with VP of Engineering Eric Johnson
1. AMA with GitLab Chief Revenue Officer Michael McBride

Key Monthly Reviews

Learning and development occurs more naturally when team members are well-informed. If there are knowledge gaps in the company strategy, it's difficult to apply new learnings. Particularly in all-remote settings, it's important to make OKRs (Objectives and Key Results) visible across the company.

This allows team members to educate themselves on what matters to each functional group, enabling new learnings to map to something tangible in their day-to-day work.

{{% include "includes/isthisadviceanygoodremote.md" %}}

Contribute your lessons

GitLab believes that all-remote is the future of work, and remote companies have a shared responsibility to show the way for other organizations who are embracing it. If you or your company has an experience that would benefit the greater world, consider creating a merge request and adding a contribution to this page.

Return to the main all-remote page.

SECTION: company/culture/all-remote/live-doc-meetings.md

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On this page, we're detailing how to create efficient, transparent, documentation-based meetings leveraging GitLab's proven principles. This style of meeting increases cohesion, discipline, and transparency regardless of the work environment.

GitLab meeting best practices

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"No agenda, no attenda." Every work-related meeting should have a live doc agenda affixed to the calendar invite. To better understand how GitLab utilizes agenda docs, here's a templated example you can copy and use in your organization. Coffee chats are excluded from this given their function in informal communication.

If you determine that a meeting is needed to move a project forward, address a blocker, or resolve a miscommunication, follow the proven principles below.

Agenda and sharing

1. Create the agenda in a Google Doc ahead of time using GitLab's Agenda Template (this can be any shared document service, though GitLab uses Google Workspace). Please do not use Google Calendar's automatic agenda/notes creation function, as it does not adhere to GitLab's preferred agenda flow. If the automatic agenda doc has been created in error, edit the calendar invite and hover over the X to delete it from the agenda to avoid confusion.

1. Ensure that the appropriate sharing settings are in place to prevent a chorus of "I can't access the agenda" comments; agendas should be editable by all participants.

1. Link the agenda in the meeting invite.

1. Establish the agenda as far in advance of the meeting as possible.

1. Agendas should use numbered lists, not bulleted lists.

1. Context section includes: The goal(s) of the meeting; clear pre-work or pre-watch/read instructions; intent and expected outcomes using low-context communication.

Pre-work and meeting kick-off

1. Pre-read/watch or pre-work materials should be emailed to attendees at least 24 hours in advance.

1. The meeting host (DRI) may summarize key points and context for the first 1 to 2 minutes of the meeting, but few meetings should be presentations.

1. Questions should be written and listed in advance of the scheduled meeting time; this tends to increase the quality of questions.

Note taking and structure during the meeting

1. Make a proposal whenever feasible. It should be possible to answer/comment with a simple "yes."

1. Link any relevant piece of text to associated resources to prevent people from spending time searching or asking.

1. Follow GitLab's smart note taking guidance by taking notes inline with the agenda rather than using a separate "notes" section. Real-time note-taking by multiple participants is encouraged.

- Another good reference is the CEO Shadow handbook page tips section, specifically It's helpful if shadow one takes notes as the first speaker is talking, then shadow two starts when the next speaker continues the conversation. Shadow one can pick up note taking again when the next speaker contributes. By alternating this way, the shadows are better able to keep up with all the participants in the conversation. This advice can be used in general meetings as well.

1. If you're not talking in the meeting, at any given time, help take notes. If there isn't a note taker listed in the document at the start of the meeting, people should self-note-take.

Consider asking other people to write down the answers in real-time to allow the person who asked the question to focus on the answer. The person asking the question can touch up the answer when the conversation has moved on to something less relevant to them.

1. Notes should be properly indented and structured to follow the conversation's flow.

1. Notes do not have to be verbatim, but they should capture key points made and be clear on any decisions or next steps.

1. Preface questions and answers with the participant's name, giving context to the origin.

Inclusion and transparency in meetings

1. Follow the order of the questions instead of jumping around in the agenda; this prevents the proverbial loudest voice in the room from dominating a conversation.

1. Always ask if the name preceding the question would like to verbalize; if they wish not to, or are otherwise unavailable, the meeting host should verbalize on their behalf.

1. Reenact questions in the list by verbalizing them even if they were already asked and answered in the shared document. Hearing the question and answer allows everyone to think about it and respond to it. It might also happen that when verbalizing the question or answer more context is given since most people can talk faster and with less effort than they can type.

Another advantage if you're recording the meeting is that the recording contains everything.

1. Unless the meeting contains Not Public information, record the meeting to share with those who cannot attend live and consider livestreaming for maximum transparency and feedback potential.

1. If a portion of a meeting does not pertain to you, it's OK to look away. You are the manager of your own time and attention.

Q: What are the benefits of live doc meetings?

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Establishing a culture where team members are cognizant that they work with others who may be in a different location, or unable to attend a meeting live, is critical. Documentation is a vital part of avoiding team dysfunction.

Improving your meeting hygiene can start by shifting to live doc meetings. It is a relatively simple step, and tends to create an understanding of the value of documentation. If you're looking for a place to start in capturing team-wide buy-in on documentation, consider adding agendas to all work-related meetings and insist on live documentation during them.

1. It prevents knowledge leaks. Meetings without agendas are only useful to those in it, and even then, it's likely that outcomes will be forgotten, or critical pieces of the puzzle will become less familiar over time.
1. It creates a more inclusive meeting atmosphere. People can add questions and insights before (and even after) a synchronous meeting. Plus, those who are less comfortable verbalizing points in front of management can use the agenda doc to properly articulate their complete thoughts.
1. It creates a takeaway. The agenda doc lives longer after the meeting. If you want to share it further, perhaps sending to a person or team that you realize would have benefited from attending, you're able to do so.
1. It shifts the memorization burden away from humans. If there's an agenda doc affixed to each calendar invite, you can easily search your calendar for key words (marketing, CEO, engineering, etc.), find a given meeting, and immediately access a documented history of what was discussed.

Q: When should I use a meeting over async?

Not all meetings are inherently bad. We encourage managers to establish regular 1:1 meetings with their team, for example. There are instances where a brief synchronous chat can replace multiple hours of asynchronous work. Strategically leveraging sync and async is an art, not a science.

Many meetings can be avoided by understanding how to work well asynchronously.

For a deeper dive on how GitLab implements meetings in a remote work environment, visit our [all-remote meetings guide](#). To learn more about how GitLab communications, visit our [Communications page](#).

Q: What is a live doc meeting?

A live doc meeting is a GitLab specialty. It's a work-related meeting (e.g. not a coffee chat) where you document everything live (yes, everything)! Start documenting before the meetings begins by attaching a shared, editable agenda document to the calendar invite.

Q: What is the agenda for a live doc meeting?

Here is a [sample template](#) for a live doc meeting. Be sure to create a new Google Doc and attach a link to your live doc with every calendar invite. Please do not use Google Calendar's automatic agenda/notes creation function, as it does not adhere to GitLab's preferred agenda

flow. Include the agenda for the meeting, set the appropriate sharing permissions, and add instructions for expected engagement (in Context section) so team members understand how to contribute whether they attend synchronously or asynchronously.

Q: What is meant by 'live document'?

A live document is a document that may continually be edited and updated. Examples could include a shared Google doc, whiteboard being used by a team for collaboration, or GitLab's handbook.

Q: How can I participate in a live doc meeting?

There are two ways to participate in a live doc meeting: either synchronously, like when joining a live Zoom call, or asynchronously, by reviewing the documented discussion along with any recorded video after the meeting is over.

Q: When are live doc meetings held?

Live doc meetings are usually held in the host's time zone. However, leaders should rotate meetings to accommodate a more diverse array of time zones as well as record them so that others can watch at a later time.

Q: Where are live doc meetings held?

Live doc meetings can happen fully in-person, fully online, or a on hybrid call · which is a blend of both. It's best to have everyone on a level playing field for communication and discussion, so hybrid calls should be avoided. If a hybrid call is necessary, have participants use their own equipment (camera, headset, screen) to avoid audio problems from delays and feedback.

[Return to the main all-remote page.](#)

SECTION: company/culture/all-remote/management.md

On this page, we're detailing what it takes to effectively and efficiently manage an all-remote company.

What is all-remote management?

The pillars of managing an all-remote company are similar to managing any company, but there are certain areas where all-remote leaders need to pay particular attention.

How do you manage a 100% remote team?

In this video, GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij and InVision Chief People Officer Mark Frein discuss the future of remote work, including managing all-remote teams at scale.

"How do you manage when everyone is remote?" is a common question for those leading or managing within an all-remote company.

In truth, managing an all-remote company is much like managing any other company. It comes down to trust, communication, and company-wide support of shared goals, all of which aid in avoiding dysfunction.

Remote forces you to do the things you should be doing way earlier and better. It forces discipline that sustains culture and efficiency at scale, particularly in areas which are easily deprioritized in small colocated companies.

It's important to not assume that team members understand good remote work practices. GitLab managers are expected to coach their reports to utilize asynchronous communication, be handbook-first, design an optimal workspace, and understand the importance of self-learning/self-service.

Get certified in remote management

GitLab has partnered with Coursera to produce a ten-hour course, *How to Manage a Remote Team*. Join tens of thousands of enrollees and complete the course with a certificate in managing a remote team.

What are the benefits of all-remote management?

Work from anywhere

At GitLab, when we say our people can work from anywhere, we really mean it. We care about the results of their work, not where it's getting done.

This flexibility often means something different for each person at GitLab.

There are others who join and travel the world with remote co-working and co-living organizations.

Many of our team members appreciate the ability to still be able to work while visiting friends or family away from home.

Even for those who typically work in their home office, this flexibility means they can do things like run errands on a weekday, take their child to school, spend more time with family, or walk their dog during the day.

We have a channel on Slack called *office-today* where our team members can share photos of their work location or view on any given day.

Time away from work

It's important to clarify that being able to work from anywhere does not replace the need to take time off of work.

We recognize how crucial it is to build in time where you can mentally take a break from your work, and as a company, we encourage our team members to do that. Learn more about how time off

works at GitLab.

Dedicate time for health and fitness

It's sometimes hard to remember to stay active when you work from home. If you're an employer, it's important to be intentional about modeling self-care and overall wellness habits. Here are some tips that might help:

1. Try to step away from your computer and stretch your body every hour.
1. If possible, choose a workspace that's exposed to natural light.
1. Avoid "Digital Eye Strain" by following the 20-20-20 Rule. Every 20 minutes look into the distance (at least 20 feet/6 meters) for 20 seconds.
1. Schedule physical time on your calendar

- Go for a walk or do a short exercise for at least 15 minutes a day. Model this practice for your team by adding it to your calendar.

- > "Getting out of the house before I start my day is very important for me.
- > Either walking the dog or going for a swim to clear my head and get the blood flowing."
- > - Daniel G., Product Manager

What are the challenges of all-remote management?

We've done a deep dive on the most common drawbacks to all-remote working here. The reality is that all-remote working isn't for everyone. Most challenges can be overcome with a little creativity and flexibility.

For example, all-remote companies that have colleagues spread out across time zones will encounter scenarios where one has to compromise in order to be online at the same time for critical calls, meetings, or projects. However, there is great freedom in being able to disconnect from work at an appointed time with the understanding that your colleagues will communicate asynchronously rather than pressuring you to be available outside of your work hours.

As documented in the Communication section of GitLab's Handbook, there are limits to asynchronous communication. When we go back and forth three times, we jump on a synchronous video call.

Remote management tools

Similar to managing employees in-person, a remote manager must use their leadership skills to create communication, systems, and workflows that sets up their remote employees for success.

Embracing total transparency

{{< youtube "-XBIIY2pFpc?start=33" >}}

In the video above, published to GitLab's YouTube channel, support engineering manager Lee M. explains how all-remote enables DevOps and how transparency plays a key role in a team's success.

Transparency is a term that is often tossed around as a value within most companies. In all-remote environments, it is vital that transparency be more than a buzzword, but something that is embraced and allowed to guide every decision.

This will often feel unnatural and uncomfortable · a sign that your organization truly is living out the value of transparency.

It helps to recognize all-remote organizations not as a collection of rigidly structured machines, but as a living, evolving organism. Leaders must trust their colleagues to operate with empathy, kindness, and concern for the well-being of one another, seeing the free flow of information as universally beneficial.

Learn more on how GitLab defines and implements transparency in our Handbook.

Managing time zones in a remote team

The ideal way to think about time zones in a remote team is to assume every team member is in a vastly different time zone, even if they aren't (yet). As you scale a team, it becomes increasingly possible that a manager and direct report, for example, could be on opposite sides of the world and will need to foster a functioning working relationship.

Remember that someone's home time zone will not necessarily represent their day-to-day time zone. Plus, someone working in a given time zone may prefer to work a nonlinear workday. Time zones are only one element which impacts when a team member works. Optimizing for nearness in time zones creates a business continuity risk; proactive communication about one's time zone and associated work expectations are critical.

Practically, the following should be considered.

1. Leaders should proactively optimize as many workflows as possible for asynchronous. This enables people to work when they are most productive, fosters a culture of rich documentation, and creates a more inclusive work environment.
1. Attempt to align on a time, or a rotation of times, where the manager and direct report can be online at the same time for a regular 1-1. If this pulls one person or the other into non-working hours, consider rotating times so the burden is equally shared.
1. Document what success looks like using Objectives and Key Results (OKRs). This should be conveyed plainly and mutually agreed upon.
1. Foster community and mentorship with like time zones. E.g. If a manager gains a new direct report with a sizable time zone gap, ask others in the organization · even if they are not in the same department · who are more aligned with the time zone to include this person in their social activities.
1. Lean on documentation. Place importance on using low-context communication in 1-1 documents, GitLab issues/merge requests, etc.
1. Consider using tools like Yac and Loom to convey thoughts and feedback with video and audio if the written word feels too impersonal. Managers should flex to the preferred medium and style of their direct report, and encourage open conversation to iterate on this as the relationship develops.
1. Meet in-person. When possible (e.g. at onsite GitLab Contribute gatherings), prioritize spending in-person time with those who have little overlap in virtual working hours. These opportunities may arise at company retreats, events, and through serendipity in personal

travel.

1. Celebrate differences. For example, working with someone experiencing summer while you experience winter is remarkable. Lifestyle differences are an opportunity to learn and expand one's worldview, and this includes time zone differences.

You can also learn from the experiences of GitLab team members collected in this survey from late 2021.

Handbook, goals, and documentation

{{< youtube "HhlqwJsNyM" >}}

In the GitLab Unfiltered video above, Darren (GitLab) and Anna-Karin (Because Mondays) discuss a number of challenges and solutions related to remote work, transitioning a company to remote, working asynchronously, and defaulting to documentation.

Remote work is what led to the development of our publicly viewable handbook, which captures everything you'd need to know about the company. If you can't tell, we like efficiency and don't like having to explain things twice.

Each department and team's quarterly goals, or "objectives and key results" (OKRs), are also clearly documented in our handbook for visibility across the company. We check in on these goals monthly, so there's as much transparency as possible around what each team is accomplishing.

Our approach to documentation also helps with onboarding new team members, because everything they need to know is in one place.

We also have an extensive onboarding template and we host a GitLab 101 for new hires to ask questions.

Using GitLab for remote collaboration

GitLab relies on GitLab to build, sustain, and evolve its company handbook. GitLab is a collaboration tool designed to help people work better together whether they are in the same location or spread across multiple time zones. Originally, GitLab let software developers collaborate on writing code and packaging it up into software applications. Today, GitLab has a wide range of capabilities used by people around the globe in all kinds of companies and roles.

You can learn more at GitLab's remote team solutions page.

Docs instead of whiteboards

We're often asked, "But how do you whiteboard without everyone physically together?" We use Google Docs for collaboration. Every meeting has a Google Doc agenda, which is used for documenting discussions, decisions, and actions. Everyone in the meeting can add notes at the same time, and we even finish each other's sentences sometimes.

By brainstorming in text instead of drawings, we're forced to clearly articulate proposals, designs, and ideas, with less variance in interpretations. A picture may be worth a thousand

words, but it's also open to as many interpretations as there are people viewing it. This breaks down silos by having information easily accessible and allows for team members to work together quickly to achieve our shared goals.

With Google Docs, we use indentations to go more in-depth on a given topic. This method retains context for comments, discussions, and ideas, even if someone wasn't present for the original conversation.

Docs instead of water coolers

Documentation also helps with transparency, which is critical to remote work. While decisions made around office water coolers may be familiar in traditional workplaces, input is limited to those present.

Those who are not present feel left out, and you're missing an opportunity to hear different perspectives.

The GitLab way of working is more inclusive. By documenting everything, no one is left out of the conversation and a diverse set of perspectives can be heard, not only from GitLab team members but also from customers and community contributors.

Scaling by documenting

{{< youtube "2g-XmZeB2qk?start=853" >}}

In the interview above between GitLab co-founder Sid Sijbrandij and The New Stack's Alex Williams, Sid explains the importance of "handbook first" when it comes to maintaining velocity and efficiency in scaling a team.

> Because we're all-remote, we've been forced to adopt a lot of best practices early on. It scales a lot better. If you're colocated and on the same floor, that works well. If you're on multiple floors in the same building, that starts to deteriorate a bit. If you're in multiple buildings in the same city, that gets worse. If you're in multiple cities, it's harder, and if you're in multiple countries, it starts to break down. It's how most companies work, and that's one of the reasons why companies are really hard to scale.

>

> We never scaled by doing that. We always scaled by writing things down and recording things. As we grow bigger, it's paying off.

>

> At GitLab, we have a rule that says handbook first. If you're going to communicate a change to people, first put it in the handbook and then communicate that change to people.

>

> Our handbook has grown to over 3,000 pages · it's impossible to read all of it · but you're going to read the sections that are relevant to the job that you have to do. We encourage people to record things and share things. We're continuously trying to move conversations out of Slack and into GitLab Issues where everyone can see them. We encourage people to stream to YouTube on GitLab Unfiltered. - GitLab co-founder, Sid Sijbrandij

This is one of the harder things to apply on a daily basis. Taking the time to document a solution isn't very satisfying in the moment, and is easy to deprioritize when other seemingly urgent tasks are vying for your attention.

To relieve tension, empower DRIs to make decisions, and create a more productive future for a team, it's vital to place a high degree of value on pausing to document. This requires leadership to praise and reward the act of documenting, measuring these contributions as diligently as one would measure sales or conversions.

This applies to all companies, though it can produce outsized gains in all-remote organizations where there are fewer opportunities for information to be shared in a physical space.

This also requires humility, and a recognition that human memories aren't perfect. It's impossible to predict the future, but documenting a solution as soon as it is discovered guarantees that the answer will be available should it ever be needed later.

Asynchronous

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When you open your talent acquisition pipeline to the world, you create an opportunity to hire people in an array of time zones. The ability to hand projects off across time zones is a competitive advantage, but minimizing disconnects, frustrations, and awkwardly-timed meetings requires an intentional approach.

Active reinforcement

The first step in creating an atmosphere where colleagues are comfortable working asynchronously is to avoid the default mentality as it applies to meetings. By making meetings optional, recording and documenting everything, being diligent to follow an agenda, and leveraging tools like GitLab Issues and Slack, all-remote companies are less reliant on colleagues being online at the same time.

This mentality must be actively reinforced. For example, in team social calls where dozens of people join a video chat to bond as a team, an agenda allows those who cannot make it to add shout-outs or discussion points that a fellow colleague can verbalize. This is an intentional approach to not only working asynchronously, but socializing asynchronously.

Leonardo Federico, co-founder at Sametab, offers an interesting perspective on asynchronous communication, noting that it provides more optionality.

> [Asynchronous] allows you to reorganize the company in a divisional organization more easily and embrace remote working even if you're colocated. Everything that works in an async fashion can also work sync but not vice-versa.

Benefits for morale, well-being, and lowering stress

{{< youtube "cy6WGuzArgY?start=2018" >}}

Emna G., founder and CEO at Veamly and GitLab's Darren M. discuss why asynchronous is the future.

>Asynchronous versus synchronous is traditionally seen as a process choice. What we've found at

GitLab is that it's also a cultural element.

>

>Being fully committed to asynchronous communication can improve morale and well-being. If you operate with a mindset of having no other colleagues online at the same time, it forces you to encapsulate your work on a project in a way that can be ingested by others at a time convenient to them. This not only improves documentation, but it relieves everyone of the burdens associated with needing to be at work at the same time.

>

>When you approach your work in this manner, it's less chaotic. The sense of urgency is not on rushing something out, but on the thoroughness and thoughtfulness in documentation. · Darren M., GitLab

There are considerations that go beyond productivity metrics. Companies should ask if demanding synchronous communication is impacting their team's ability to reason and process challenges in the most efficient and healthy way.

> With synchronous communication, the problem is that it creates a fake sense of emergency. It creates a heavy interruptive environment with a lot of context switching. You end up highly stressed all the time.

>

> We don't realize it because we, as a society, are so used to our stress. We live with it, and we don't even know what a life without bad stress is. By removing that interruptive effect [with asynchronous communication], that's how we go into the future.

>

> We cannot sustain, as a humanity, this way of life. We cannot keep up with it. · Emna G., founder and CEO at Veamy

Asynchronous communication alone will not solve challenges associated with remote work, but it is a useful tool in a wider arsenal of tactics to avoid issues such as burnout.

Time and productivity

When referencing time and productivity, Remote CTO Marcelo Lebre shares a potent thought on asynchronous communication in a relevant blog post.

> Async communication shines with great power here, as it shields everyone's time and focus while reducing meaningless time sinks. When you're communicating async, this types of interruptions happen much less. And the total time that you're able to do deep work is longer, the chance of achieving Flow much higher.

Learn more about GitLab's approach to asynchronous working by viewing our Efficiency and Collaboration values.

Separating deci